📚 Daily Editorial Vocabulary — Master List

1416 words in 396 meaning-families 13 new today. Near-synonyms share ONE row — the whole family, one meaning, one example, with the interchangeable words in (brackets) at the swap point.

How to use: read the example aloud swapping in each word of the family, then cover the meaning and recall it.

🆕 **Added today:** Administrations, Civilization, Contradiction, Decentralisation, Devolution, Environmentally, Homelessness, Improbable, Intellectuals, Investigating, Presumption, Prominence, Traditional

🧭 Contents

#	Group	Families	Words
1	📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken	17	76
2	📈 Increase, Rise & Spread	23	43
3	💢 Criticism & Condemnation	9	57
4	👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen	23	69
5	🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress	12	64
6	⚔️ Conflict, Crisis & Disorder	11	47
7	💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen	3	12

#	Group	Families	Words
8	🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency	22	48
9	❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt	11	50
10	🌱 Beginnings, Change & Turning Points	10	38
11	💰 Wealth, Money & Economy	17	65
12	🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom	10	34
13	🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims	18	61
14	⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal	10	31
15	🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards	2	16
16	🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation	6	46
17	⭐ Certainty, Importance & Authority	8	45
18	🌫️ Hidden, Unclear & Secret	10	26
19	🧱 Real, Concrete & Practical	2	3
20	✊ Reject, Revenge & Force	3	21

#	Group	Families	Words
21	⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach	9	32
22	🎭 Lies, Trickery & Deception	6	17
23	🚧 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks	7	18
24	🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory	4	28
25	⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth	13	26
26	🌀 Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness	7	14
27	👑 Power, Control & Influence	2	8
28	😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity	6	12
29	🌑 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant	9	42
30	📦 Amount, Size & Plenty	18	34
31	◻️ Difference, Comparison & Opposite	3	4
32	🪤 Catch, Hold & Seize	2	7
33	📌 Cause, Effect & Consequence	6	32
34	🔺 Highest & Lowest Points	2	4

#	Group	Families	Words
35	🗨️ Talkative, Loud & Wordy	2	6
36	🤠 Boldness, Recklessness & Daring	2	4
37	😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint	4	8
38	▯ Unity, Sameness & Division	3	5
39	🌟 Quality, Character & Behaviour	19	56
40	Other & Mixed	30	30
41	🧬 Word Roots, Prefixes & Latin Phrases	8	74
42	🏛️ Polity, Government & Civics	4	55
43	🔧 Science, Work & Industry	3	48

📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abate, Ebb, Recede, Wane, Dwindle, Diminish	verb	to gradually become less, smaller or weaker	*As the crisis passed, public anger began to (abate / ebb / recede / wane / dwindle / diminish).*
Allay, Alleviate, Mitigate, Ease, Dampen	verb	to make a fear, pain or problem less severe	*The package was meant to (allay / alleviate / mitigate /*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			ease / dampen) public anxiety.
Contraction, Deflation, Depreciation, Depression, Stagnation	noun	an economic shrinking, fall or standstill	*Contraction = output shrinking; deflation = a general fall in prices; depreciation = a fall in the value of a currency or asset; depression = a very deep, long collapse; stagnation = a long period with no growth at all.*
Curb, Curtail, Whittle, Attenuate	verb	to deliberately cut back, limit or reduce something	*New rules were framed to (curb / curtail / attenuate) wasteful spending; the panel will whittle the list down to five names.*
Decline	verb	sense 1: to go down or decrease	*Enrolment has declined for the third year running.*
Decline	verb	sense 2: to politely refuse	*The minister declined to comment on the report.*
Detachment	noun	being emotionally distant; also a small group of troops sent on a separate task	*He described the tragedy with clinical detachment; a detachment of soldiers was sent to the border.*
Deteriorate, Languish, Wither, Unravel	verb	to get steadily worse or fall apart	*Without funding the scheme began to (deteriorate / wither / unravel); thousands languish in overcrowded jails.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Deteriorating, Stagnant, Downturn, Recession, Plateau, Diminishing returns, Devaluation, Deindustrialisation	noun/adjective	getting worse, shrinking or losing momentum, especially in an economy.	*Output is (deteriorating / stagnant); the (downturn / recession) deepened, growth hit a plateau, and diminishing returns set in after the devaluation and deindustrialisation.*
Erode, Undermine, Subvert, Cripple, Debilitate, Enervate	verb	to weaken or damage something, often gradually or secretly	*Corruption has (eroded / undermined / subverted / crippled / debilitated / enervated) public trust in the institution. Note: subvert = weaken secretly to overthrow; cripple = damage severely.*
Feeble, Fragile, Tenuous, Vulnerable	adjective	weak, easily broken or easily harmed	*The ceasefire rests on a (feeble / fragile / tenuous) understanding; poor households are the most vulnerable to price shocks.*
Flounder, Underprepared, Underestimate, Lopsided, Inequality, Inexperience, Maladroit, Unpopularity, Unfriendliest, Nominal, Disability	noun/adjective/verb	falling short, being unfairly small, or failing to cope.	*The team (floundered / was underprepared); we (underestimate / undervalue) the gap; the lopsided deal deepened inequality, and his inexperience, maladroit handling and the resulting unpopularity made him the unfriendliest figure in the room,*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			with only nominal support.
Lethargy, Lassitude, Inertia, Malaise	noun	a state of tiredness, sluggishness or unwillingness to act	*A deep (lethargy / lassitude / inertia / malaise) has settled over the bureaucracy. Note: inertia = resistance to change; malaise = a vague sense that something is unwell.*
Mar, Dent, Flaw	noun/verb	a fault that spoils something, or to spoil it	*The riots (marred / dented) the state's image; a single flaw in the design brought the bridge down.*
Moribund, Inert, Languid, Lethargic, Tepid, Halfhearted, Perfunctory	adjective	lacking energy, effort or life	*The response was (inert / languid / lethargic / tepid / halfhearted / perfunctory); the once-great mill is now moribund. Note: moribund = about to die out completely.*
Plummet, Plunge, Slump, Lag	verb	to fall fast, steeply or behind	*Exports (plummeted / plunged / slumped) after the ban; India continues to lag behind its neighbours on this index.*
Resignation, Abdication	noun	formally stepping down from a position or right.	*His (resignation / abdication) ended the crisis.*

📈 Increase, Rise & Spread ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Accelerate, Facilitate, Facilitation, Encroach, Encroachment, Inundate, Contagious, Pandemic	verb/noun	to grow, speed up, spread out or push into new ground.	*Reforms (accelerated / facilitated) growth; the (encroachment / spread) was rapid, cheap credit inundated the market, and the contagious optimism went pandemic.*
circum	root	root CIRCUM = around	*circumference, circumnavigate, circumspect.*
cred	root	root CRED = believe	*credit, credible, incredible, credentials.*
dict	root	root DICT = say, speak	*dictate, predict, contradict, verdict.*
Disseminate, Diffuse	verb	to spread something widely; *diffuse* also = to calm a tense situation	*The app (disseminated / diffused) weather alerts to millions; talks helped diffuse the tension.*
Escalate, Soar, Surge, Proliferate, Wax	verb	to rise, grow or spread quickly; *wax* = to increase gradually	*Prices (escalated / soared / surged) after the ban; misinformation proliferated online while the party's influence waxed.*
Exodus	noun	a large number of people leaving a place	*The lockdown triggered an exodus of migrant workers.*
Germinate, Germinal	verb/adjective	to begin to grow or develop, like a seed or an idea; *germinal* = at the earliest stage	*The idea germinated in a college seminar; the paper is the germinal work in the field.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Hike	verb	to raise a price or rate	*The bank hiked interest rates again.*
Increasingly	adverb	more and more over time	*Cities are increasingly reliant on tanker water.*
Inflation	noun	the general rise in prices over time	*Food inflation stayed above eight per cent.*
magn	root	root MAGN = great, large	*magnify, magnificent, magnitude, magnate.*
Magnitude, Measure	noun/verb	the size or scale of something; to find out that size	*No one grasped the magnitude of the loss; the study measured its true cost.*
mal	root	root MAL = bad	*malice, malevolent, malfunction, malign.*
Marginalise	verb	to push a group to the edges of society and ignore their needs	*The policy further marginalised landless labourers.*
Overwhelming	verb	engulf, surge over and submerge	*India's 'cockroach' protest continues a day after police crackdown Delhi witnessed overwhelming violence on Monday, with at least 60 protesters wounded.*
Prevalence	noun	how common or widespread something is	*The survey measured the prevalence of anaemia among children.*
Rampant, Rife, Ubiquitous	adjective	very common and spreading everywhere, usually of	*Corruption was (rampant / rife) in the department;*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		something bad; *ubiquitous* = present everywhere	*smartphones are now ubiquitous.*
re-	prefix	prefix RE- = again, back	*rewrite, return, rebuild, revise.*
super-/sur-	prefix	prefix SUPER-/SUR- = above, over	*superman, supervise, surplus, surface.*
Surge, Hike, Expansion, Ascendancy	noun	a sudden or sustained increase in level, price or power	*A (surge / hike) in fuel rates followed; the decade saw rapid expansion and the ascendancy of a new elite.*
Sustainable, Holistic	adjective	able to continue long-term; taking the whole into account rather than parts	*The plan is neither (sustainable / holistic) nor affordable.*
Yield	verb	to produce or give a result or amount	*The new seed yields twice as much per hectare.*

Criticism & Condemnation ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Admonish, Berate, Lambast, Lambaste, Harangue, Slam, Censure, Condemn, Deplore	verb	to scold, attack or officially blame someone strongly; *censure* is the most formal, *admonish* the mildest	*The court (admonished / berated / lambasted / lambaste / slammed / censured / condemned / deplored) the delay; he (harangued) the crowd for an hour.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Castigate, Excoriate, Deride, Disparage, Vituperate	verb	to attack someone with harsh words. Castigate, excoriate and vituperate are severe; deride and disparage are mocking or belittling.	*The court (castigated / excoriated / derided / disparaged / vituperated) the officials for the delay.*
Culpable, Accountability, Onus, Obligation, Absolve, Exonerate, Vindicate	adjective	to do with being blamed or cleared of blame; *culpable* = at fault, *absolve / exonerate / vindicate* are verbs = to clear someone	*Officials were found (culpable) and (accountability) followed; the (onus) and (obligation) lay with the ministry, but the inquiry later (absolved / exonerated / vindicated) the staff.*
Denigrate, Vilify, Malign, Calumny, Invective, Obloquy, Opprobrium, Tirade	noun	abusive speech, or the public disgrace it brings; *denigrate / vilify / malign* are verbs = to run down unfairly, *calumny* = a false damaging statement, *obloquy / opprobrium* = harsh public shaming	*The campaign was pure (calumny / invective / obloquy / opprobrium), a (tirade) meant to (denigrate / vilify / malign) a rival.*
Ignominy, Humiliation, Affront, Accusation, Allegation, Defamation	noun	public disgrace, or an act or charge that wounds pride and reputation.	*He suffered the (ignominy / humiliation / affront) of public dismissal; an (accusation / allegation) followed, and he sued for defamation.*
Impudent, Brazen, Boorish, Surly,	adjective	rude, ill-mannered or unpleasant in manner; *voluble* =	*His (impudent / brazen / boorish / surly / petulant) reply*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Petulant, Obtuse, Voluble		talking non-stop, *obtuse* = slow to understand	*showed him to be (obtuse); a (voluble) speaker filled the rest of the hour.*
Lament, Bemoan, Contrite, Penitent	verb	to express sorrow or regret; *contrite / penitent* are adjectives = feeling deep remorse for a wrong	*Leaders (lament / bemoan) the loss; the (contrite / penitent) official offered to resign.*
Notorious, Reprehensible, Egregious, Flagrant, Glaring, Heinous, Iniquity	adjective	openly and shockingly bad, deserving blame; *iniquity* is a noun = great wickedness or injustice	*A (notorious / reprehensible / egregious / flagrant / glaring / heinous) breach of duty exposed the (iniquity) of the system.*
Scathing, Vitriolic, Acrimonious, Indictment	adjective	bitterly harsh in criticism; *indictment* is a noun = a formal charge or a damning verdict on something	*The (scathing / vitriolic) report followed an (acrimonious) debate and reads as an (indictment) of the whole scheme.*

👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abet	verb	to help someone do something wrong	*Officials were accused of aiding and abetting illegal sand mining.*
Acclaim, Approbation	noun	strong public praise and approval	*The reform won wide (acclaim / approbation) from economists.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Advocate, Stalwart	noun	a loyal, reliable supporter of a cause	*She has been a lifelong (advocate / stalwart) of press freedom.*
Backbone, Keystone, Collateral	noun	the main supporting part on which something rests; *collateral* = the asset pledged to back a loan	*Small farms are the (backbone / keystone) of the rural economy; the loan required land as collateral.*
Bolster, Boost, Underpin, Augment, Foster, Embolden	verb	to support, strengthen or encourage the growth of something; *underpin* = form the base of; *embolden* = give courage	*The subsidy (bolstered / boosted / augmented / fostered) rural demand; strong institutions underpin democracy; the win emboldened the protesters.*
Boost, Impetus, Stimulus, Incentive	noun	something that pushes an activity forward or encourages action	*The tax cut gave a much-needed (boost / impetus / stimulus / incentive) to manufacturing.*
Corroborate, Substantiate, Verify	verb	to prove or back up a claim with evidence	*Independent data (corroborated / substantiated / verified) the whistleblower's account.*
Egalitarian, Meritocracy	adjective/noun	based on equal treatment or on rising by talent rather than birth	*He pushed an egalitarian tax policy; the exam system is meant to be a meritocracy.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Endeavour	noun	a serious effort to achieve something	*The mission was a bold scientific endeavour.*
Endorse, Espouse, Advocate, Ratify	verb	to publicly support, approve or adopt a cause or agreement; *ratify* = formal approval of a treaty	*The party (endorsed / espoused / advocated) the new labour code; Parliament finally ratified the treaty.*
Enfranchise	verb	to give someone the right to vote or full citizenship rights	*The amendment enfranchised millions of young voters.*
Laud, Hail, Eulogise, Acclaim	verb	to praise someone or something publicly	*Critics (lauded / hailed / eulogised / acclaimed) the new welfare scheme.*
Laudable, Warranted	adjective	deserving praise, or justified by the facts	*The effort was (laudable / warranted) given the scale of the crisis.*
Magnanimous, Magnanimity, Munificent, Munificence, Benevolent, Benign, Altruistic, Lavish	adjective/noun	kind, well-meaning and generous in giving. Magnanimity and munificence are the noun forms; altruistic = selflessly caring for others; benign = gentle and harmless; lavish = giving very freely.	*A (magnanimous / munificent / benevolent / altruistic / lavish) donor funded the school; her (magnanimity / munificence) was widely praised, and the gesture was entirely benign.*
Pledge, Vow, Covenant	verb/noun	a serious, formal promise; to promise firmly	*The government (pledged / vowed) to double spending on health; the two states signed a covenant on water sharing.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Recoup	verb	to get back money or losses	*Airlines struggled to recoup pandemic losses.*
Resilience	noun	the ability to recover quickly after a shock or disaster	*The community showed remarkable resilience after the floods.*
Restoration	noun	the process of bringing something back to its original state	*The restoration of the old fort took five years.*
Staunch, Steadfast, Stalwart, Resilient	adjective	firmly loyal, unwavering and able to withstand difficulty	*He remained a (staunch / steadfast / stalwart) defender of the constitution; the economy proved resilient.*
Strengthening, Emulate, Therapeutic, Salubrious, Innocuous, Tractable	verb/adjective	to build up, back or make stronger; also to copy someone you admire.	*The reform is (strengthening / emulating) the best global practice; the therapeutic and salubrious effects were clear, and the innocuous change met no resistance.*
Thrive	verb	to grow well and become very successful	*Start-ups thrive where regulation is light.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Venerate, Reverence, Reverent, Venerable, Pious, Sacrosanct, Inviolable	noun/adjective/verb	deep respect, or showing it. Venerate = to revere deeply (verb); venerable = respected because of age or wisdom; pious = religiously devoted; sacrosanct and inviolable = too sacred or important to be touched or broken.	*Students (venerate / revere) the venerable teacher; he spoke with (reverence / a reverent tone); the pious crowd treated the shrine as (sacrosanct / inviolable).*
Woo, Garner	verb	to win over or gather support, votes or attention	*The party (wooed / garnered) young voters ahead of the polls.*

🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Avert, Forestall, Preclude, Obviate, Deter	verb	to act in time so that something bad never happens; *deter* = to put someone off by fear of consequences, *obviate* = to remove the need for something	*Early warning helped (avert / forestall / preclude) a famine; heavy fines (deter) offenders; a good design (obviates) the need for repairs.*
Blockade, Embargo, Moratorium, Interdict	noun	an official ban, sealing-off or temporary stop on trade, movement or an activity; *interdict* is also used as a verb = to stop officially	*The council imposed a (blockade / embargo / moratorium) on new mining; patrols (interdict) smuggled goods.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Cumbersome, Intractable, Wayward, Fractious, Relentless	adjective	hard to handle, hard to solve or impossible to stop	*The (cumbersome) rulebook makes an (intractable) problem worse; a (wayward / fractious) coalition faced (relentless) pressure.*
Deplete, Forfeit, Cede, Capitulate, Abandon	verb	to use up, give up or surrender something; *deplete* = to drain a stock, *forfeit* = to lose as a penalty	*Drought (depletes) reserves; the club had to (forfeit) the match; rebels chose to (cede / capitulate) rather than fight on, and (abandon) their posts.*
Docile, Mollycoddle, Complacent, Indolent	adjective	easily controlled, over-protected or too relaxed to act; *mollycoddle* is a verb = to pamper	*A (docile) workforce asks no questions; parents who (mollycoddle) children raise (complacent / indolent) adults.*
Halt, Stall, Stem, Throttle, Quell, Subdue	verb	to stop, hold back or bring under control, sometimes by force; *quell / subdue* = put down resistance	*Troops moved to (halt / stem / quell / subdue) the riot; red tape (stalls / throttles) new projects.*
Hamper, Hinder, Impede, Stymie, Thwart, Derail, Disrupt	verb	to block, slow down or spoil something so it cannot go forward	*Bad roads (hamper / hinder / impede / stymie / thwart) relief work; protesters tried to (derail / disrupt) the talks.*
Interregnum, Hiatus, Ceasefire, Cancellation	noun	a pause, gap or break in an ongoing activity or rule	*A three-month (hiatus / interregnum) followed the (cancellation) of the session; both sides agreed to a (ceasefire).*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Obfuscate, Obscure, Opaque, Nebulous, Vague, Ambiguous, Equivocal	adjective	unclear, hazy or hard to see through; *obfuscate* is a verb = to make unclear on purpose, *equivocal* = deliberately vague to avoid commitment	*The reply was (vague / ambiguous / nebulous / equivocal); the accounts stay (opaque / obscure) because officials (obfuscate) the figures.*
Pedestrianised	verb	restrict access to to pedestrians only, disallowing motor vehicles	*In the big pedestrianised square Plaza de Olavide, fans had gathered around screens, some sitting on the ground while children and dogs ran around.*
Repression, Subjugate, Yoke, Authoritarianism, Totalitarianism, Authoritarian, Regime	noun	harsh control that crushes people's freedom; *authoritarian* = a ruler demanding total obedience, *regime* = the ruling government itself	*Under the (regime), (repression) and the (yoke) of censorship grew; (authoritarianism / totalitarianism) leaves no room for dissent; the army moved to (subjugate) the region.*
Suppression, Prohibition, Nullify, Ostracise, Sanctioned, Deportation, Extradition, Imprisonment, Protectionism	noun/verb	to stop, forbid, cancel or push something down by force of authority. Note: *sanctioned* is a contronym — it usually means hit with official penalties, but can also mean officially approved; read the context.	*The order brought (suppression / prohibition) of the protest; the ruling nullified the licence, activists were ostracised and sanctioned, and deportation, extradition and imprisonment followed under a wall of protectionism.*

⚔️ Conflict, Crisis & Disorder ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Belligerent, Pugnacious, Truculent	adjective	aggressive and eager to fight or argue	*He turned (belligerent / pugnacious / truculent) when questioned.*
Cataclysm, Fiasco, Turbulence, Reel, Brunt, Knell, Nemesis, Pyrrhic	noun/verb	a violent disturbance, a total failure, or the shock that follows one.	*The policy ended in a (cataclysm / fiasco); the turbulence made markets reel, the poor bore the brunt, and it sounded the knell for the party's old nemesis.*
Debacle, Travesty	noun	a humiliating failure or a mockery of the real thing	*The rollout was a debacle; the inquiry was a travesty of justice.*
Diplomacy, Neutrality, Proxy, Compromise	noun	managing conflict without direct war	*Diplomacy = managing relations between states through talks; neutrality = refusing to take sides; a proxy is a group fighting on another's behalf; a compromise is a deal where each side gives something up (compromise can also mean to weaken or expose something).*
Factional, Polarise, Polarisation, Schism, Partition, Secession, Cleave	verb/noun/adjective	splitting into rival or separate parts	*Factional fighting (polarised / cleaved) the party; the polarisation deepened into an open schism,*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			echoing the partition of 1947 and later demands for secession.
Hostilities, Discord, Opposition, Grievance	noun	open fighting, disagreement or complaint	*Hostilities resumed along the border; discord within the party grew as the opposition seized on a long-standing grievance.*
Impasse, Stalemate	noun	a situation where neither side can move forward	*Talks reached an (impasse / stalemate).*
Insurgency, Belligerence, Brinkmanship, Fraught, Precarious, Resistance, Dissent, Dissident, Disobedience, Interference	noun/adjective	hostility, armed opposition, open disagreement, or a dangerously tense situation.	*The (insurgency / belligerence / brinkmanship) put the region on edge; (dissent / disobedience / resistance) spread, dissidents were arrested, and the situation grew (fraught / precarious) amid foreign interference.*
Kowtow, Obsequious	verb/adjective	behaving in a weak, servile way to please the powerful	*Officials kowtow to the minister; his obsequious praise embarrassed everyone.*
Schadenfreude	noun	pleasure taken in another person's misfortune	*There was open schadenfreude at the rival firm's collapse.*
Turmoil, Upheaval, Tumultuous, Turbulent	noun/adjective	great disorder, confusion or violent change	*The country passed through (turmoil / upheaval) in a*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			(tumultuous / turbulent) decade.

💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Aggravate, Exacerbate	verb	to make a bad situation worse	*Fresh curbs only (aggravate / exacerbate) the shortage.*
Annihilate, Demolish, Eradicate, Destruction, Elimination, Discard, Truncate	verb/noun	to get rid of something completely, or cut it down.	*The blast (annihilated / demolished / eradicated) the block; the (destruction / elimination) was total, the debris was discarded, and the report was truncated.*
Hapless, Fortuitous, Random	adjective	governed by chance rather than plan; *hapless* = unlucky and helpless, *fortuitous* = luckily unplanned	*The (hapless) crew survived by a (fortuitous), (random) turn of the tide.*

🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Austerity	noun	strict economic policy with sharply reduced public spending	*Years of austerity hollowed out public services.*
Backlash	noun	a strong, angry public reaction against	*The order triggered a fierce backlash from*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		something	*farmers.*
Breach	noun	the breaking of a rule, law or promise	*The order was a clear breach of privacy law.*
Coerce, Compel, Goad, Provoke	verb	to force, push or deliberately drive someone into acting; *goad/provoke* = to needle into a reaction	*Officials (coerced / compelled) traders to comply; the remarks (goaded / provoked) the crowd.*
Comeuppance	noun	a punishment or fate that is justly deserved	*The scam's masterminds finally got their comeuppance.*
Compound, Fester, Escalate	verb	to make a bad situation worse or grow more serious over time	*Delays (compounded / escalated) the crisis; the grievance was left to fester.*
Corruption	noun	the act of impairing integrity or moral principle; dishonest use of power	*Corruption in procurement drained the budget.*
Daunting, Imminent, Looming	adjective	frighteningly difficult, or about to happen very soon	*The task was daunting, with an (imminent / looming) deadline.*
Dire, Acute, Drastic, Stringent, Onerous, Gruelling	adjective	extremely serious, severe or hard to bear; *stringent* = strict; *onerous/gruelling* = heavy and exhausting	*The report warned of a (dire / acute) water shortage; the government took drastic steps and imposed stringent rules; the onerous, gruelling paperwork deterred applicants.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Escalation	noun	a rise in the intensity of a conflict or dispute	*Both sides warned against further escalation along the border.*
Famine, Starvation	noun	severe, widespread lack of food causing hunger and death	*Drought pushed the region towards (famine / starvation).*
Fervent, Vehement, Emphatic, Trenchant, Compelling	adjective	expressed with strong, forceful feeling or conviction; *trenchant* = sharp and cutting; *compelling* = very convincing	*She made a (fervent / vehement / emphatic) appeal for calm; his trenchant, compelling critique changed the debate.*
Implore, Urge	verb	to request strongly and earnestly	*Doctors (implored / urged) the public to stay indoors.*
Indict, Allege, Blame	verb	to accuse someone of wrongdoing; *indict* = formally charge	*The agency (indicted / blamed) the contractor and alleged large-scale fraud.*
Jingoism, Populism, Autocracy, Clientelism	noun	political styles based on aggressive nationalism, mass appeal, one-man rule, or favour-trading	*The speech slid into jingoism; critics saw populism, clientelism and creeping autocracy in the new order.*
Levity, Frivolous	noun/adjective	lack of seriousness; treating a serious matter lightly	*There is no room for levity in a public health crisis; the court dismissed the frivolous petition.*
Loom	verb	to appear close and threatening; to be about to happen	*A fresh crisis looms over the sector.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Plea	noun	an urgent and emotional request	*The court heard a plea for immediate relief.*
Sanction	noun/verb	a penalty imposed on a country; or, oppositely, official permission	*The council imposed sanctions on the regime; the ministry sanctioned the new post.*
Significant	adjective	large or important enough to matter, especially in results	*The trial showed a significant drop in infections.*
Systemic	adjective	affecting a whole system, not just one part; built into how things work	*The audit exposed systemic failures in the supply chain.*
Zealot, Hardliner, Demagogue	noun	a person holding extreme, uncompromising views; *demagogue* = a leader who stirs emotion rather than facts	*The party was captured by (zealots / hardliners); the campaign was led by a demagogue.*

❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Defy, Flout, Spurn, Repudiate, Disenfranchise	verb	to openly refuse, reject or strip away; *flout* = to break a rule openly, *disenfranchise* = to take away someone's rights	*Traders (defy / flout) the ban and (spurn / repudiate) the deal; the new list (disenfranchises) thousands of voters.*
Demonstrators	noun	One who demonstrates	*On Tuesday night, demonstrators' calls were answered as the*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		anything, or proves beyond doubt	*Ukrainian president fired the general and offered Mr Fedorov a "prominent" role and promised an overhaul of the army command.*
dis-, mis-	prefix	prefixes meaning 'opposite / away' (dis-) and 'wrong / badly' (mis-)	*(dis-) gives disagree, dishonest, disappear; (mis-) gives misunderstand, misguide, misuse.*
Disappointment, Deficit	noun	a shortfall — of expectation or of money	*The result was a (disappointment); the budget showed a widening (deficit).*
Disparate, Discordant, Contentious, Tussle	adjective	clashing or likely to cause conflict; *tussle* is a noun = a struggle for control	*A (disparate / discordant) alliance took up the (contentious) bill, and a long (tussle) followed.*
Disparity, Discrepancy, Deviation, Inconsistencies, Gulf, Fissure, Lacuna, Margin, Margin of error, Outlier	noun	a gap, mismatch or difference between things that should match; *lacuna* = a missing part in a law or argument, *outlier* = a value far from the rest	*The (disparity / discrepancy / gulf / fissure) between the two figures was clear; auditors flagged (deviation), (inconsistencies), a (lacuna) in the rules, a wide (margin) / (margin of error), and one (outlier).*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Misconception, Misnomer, Misinformation, Misrepresented, Misunderstood, Perplex, Anomaly, Aberration	noun/verb/adjective	a wrong idea, or the act of getting something wrong or being wrongly named.	*The claim rests on a (misconception / misnomer / piece of misinformation); the data was (misrepresented / misunderstood), which perplexed readers, and the anomaly proved to be a mere aberration.*
Nuance, Threshold, Benchmark, Yardstick	noun	a fine distinction or a fixed point used for comparison; *nuance* = a small but important shade of meaning	*Every (nuance) matters once a score crosses the (threshold); the scheme became the (benchmark / yardstick) for others.*
Tantamount	adjective	equal to or the same as something (usually something bad)	*Silence here is (tantamount) to consent.*
Uncertainty, Vacillate, Inconclusive	noun	doubt or the inability to settle on an answer; *vacillate* is a verb = to keep changing your mind	*(Uncertainty) grew as the tests stayed (inconclusive) and the board continued to (vacillate).*
Untenable, Purported, Incredulous, Credulous, Cynical, Perfidious, Perfidy, Complicit, Ambivalent, Prejudicial	adjective/noun	not believable, refusing to believe, or breaking trust.	*The defence is (untenable / purported at best); she was incredulous while a credulous public accepted it; his cynical view proved right when the (perfidious / complicit) aide's perfidy came out.*

 Beginnings, Change & Turning Points ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Amend, Adaptation, Overhaul, Intervention	noun/verb	a change made to fix or improve something	*Parliament may amend the Act; the tax system needs a complete overhaul; adaptation to a warmer climate now requires state intervention.*
Entrench, Hidebound, Persist, Obdurate, Obstinate, Intransigent, Adamant	adjective/verb	refusing to change, or fixed so firmly it cannot be changed	*Caste privilege is deeply entrenched; a hidebound bureaucracy resists reform and old habits persist; the union stayed (obdurate / obstinate / intransigent / adamant) through eight rounds of talks.*
Heterodox	adjective	not following accepted or usual beliefs	*She defended a heterodox view of growth.*
Nascent, Fledgling, Outset	adjective/noun	at the very beginning; new and inexperienced	*The (nascent / fledgling) industry needs protection; the flaw was obvious from the outset.*
Opportunities, Possibility, Feasibility, Feasible, Viable	noun/adjective	a chance, or whether something can practically be done	*Reform opened up new opportunities and raised the possibility of growth; a feasibility study found the plan (feasible / viable).*
Procrastinate	verb	to keep putting off what must be done	*The ministry procrastinated for years before acting.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Tentative	adjective	not final or certain; a first attempt that may change	*The two sides reached a tentative agreement.*
Usher, Kindle, Spark, Prompt, Galvanise, Mobilise, Catalyst	verb/noun	to set something off or stir people into action	*The verdict (sparked / prompted / kindled) protests and (galvanised / mobilised) the opposition; it ushered in a new era and became the catalyst for reform.*
Volatile, Mercurial, Instability, Vicissitude	adjective/noun	changing suddenly and unpredictably	*Oil prices remain (volatile / unstable); his mercurial temper unsettled the cabinet; instability and the vicissitudes of politics stalled the project.*
Watershed, Paradigm, Transition, Trend, Baseline	noun	a turning point, model or direction of change	*1991 was a watershed year that marked a paradigm shift; the transition to renewables is the clear trend, measured against a 2005 baseline.*

💰 Wealth, Money & Economy ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Affluent, Opulent, Lucrative	adjective	rich, or producing wealth	*They live in an (affluent / opulent) neighbourhood; software turned out to be a lucrative*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			business. Note: opulent stresses visible luxury; lucrative = profit-making.
Arrears, Indebtedness, Creditor, Leverage, Liquidity, Coffer	noun	debt, what is owed, and available money	*Arrears = overdue payments; indebtedness = the burden of owing a lot; a creditor is the one owed; leverage = borrowed money used to chase bigger profits; liquidity = how easily assets turn into spendable cash; the state's coffers are its store of funds.*
Contribution, Contributions, Contributing	noun/verb	something given that becomes part of a larger whole.	*Each member's (contribution / contributions) mattered; every donor contributing to the fund was named.*
Destitute	adjective	extremely poor, lacking even food and shelter	*The floods left thousands destitute.*
Fiscal, Monetary, Neoliberalism, Industrialisation	noun/adjective	terms describing economic policy and economic change	*Fiscal policy covers government spending and taxes, while monetary policy covers money supply and interest rates; neoliberalism favours free markets and trade liberalisation; industrialisation is the shift from a pre-*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			industrial to an industrial economy.
Frugal, Husbandry	adjective/noun	careful, non-wasteful management of money and resources	*A frugal household saves where it can; careful husbandry of water made the district drought-proof.*
Generous	adjective	willing to give freely (opposite: stingy)	*A generous donor funded the entire wing.*
Indigent, Penurious, Penury, Parsimonious, Prodigal, Rapacious, Scarce, Negligible	adjective/noun	extremely poor, or unwilling to spend. Prodigal is the opposite — wastefully extravagant; rapacious = aggressively greedy.	*The (indigent / penurious / parsimonious) household had nothing to spare; penury forced the sale, while his prodigal brother squandered a fortune and a rapacious lender took the rest.*
Largesse, Subsidy, Bailout, Redistribution, Remittance, Reparations, Allocate	noun/verb	money handed out, transferred or set aside	*Allocate = to set money aside for a purpose; subsidy = government money to lower a cost; bailout = emergency rescue money for a failing firm or bank; largesse = generous giving by the powerful; redistribution = sharing wealth more evenly through tax and welfare; remittance = money sent home by workers abroad; reparations =*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			money paid for war damage.
Levy, Default, Commodity, Volatility, Overheating, Insolvent, Sovereign, Macroeconomic, Globalisation, Affordable, Unaffordable, Subscription, Transactional, Misappropriation, Optimization	noun/adjective	terms about money, markets, trade and the wider economy.	*A new (levy / default / commodity) shock triggered volatility; overheating followed, firms turned insolvent, and sovereign debt strained the macroeconomic outlook amid globalisation.*
Livelihood	noun	the way a person earns a living	*The ban destroyed the livelihood of thousands of weavers.*
Magnate, Billionaires, Plutocracy	noun	the very rich, and rule by them	*A steel magnate and two billionaires bankrolled the campaign; critics call the system a plutocracy.*
Ostentatious	adjective	showing off wealth to impress others	*His ostentatious wedding drew sharp criticism.*
Prosperity	noun	the state of being rich and doing well	*Two decades of reform brought unprecedented prosperity.*
Recovery, Resurgence	noun	a rise or return to health after a fall	*The data point to a (recovery / resurgence) in rural demand.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Squander, Fritter, Profligate, Cupidity, Venal, Embezzle	verb/adjective	to waste money, or greed and corruption over money	*The board (squandered / frittered away) a decade of profits; profligate spending emptied the treasury; cupidity and venal officials let one clerk embezzle the pension fund. Note: embezzle = steal money you were trusted with.*
Voracious	adjective	wanting a very large amount; greedy or intensely eager	*The country has a voracious appetite for imported oil.*

🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Acumen	noun	the ability to think and judge quickly and well	*Her business acumen saved the firm.*
Adept, Adroit, Deft, Nimble	adjective	skilful, clever and quick	*She is (adept / adroit / deft / nimble) at handling hostile questions.*
Assiduous, Erudite, Versatile, Discernment, Arduous, Equanimity, Sangfroid	adjective/noun	showing careful effort, sound judgement, wide learning or calm control.	*She is (assiduous / erudite / versatile) and known for her discernment; the arduous negotiation demanded (equanimity / sangfroid).*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Cautious, Wary	adjective	careful about possible danger	*Investors remain (cautious / wary) about the new rules.*
Heuristic, Estimate, Variable, Control, Empirical, Correlate, Correlation, Consistent	noun/verb/adjective	the vocabulary of testing, measuring and reasoning from evidence	*A heuristic is a rough rule of thumb; an estimate is a careful guess; a variable is a factor that changes and is measured; a control group gets no treatment and is used for comparison; empirical claims rest on observation rather than theory; two things correlate when they move together, and that link is a correlation; results are consistent when they hold from test to test.*
Inept	adjective	lacking skill; clumsy and incompetent	*The rescue effort was hopelessly inept.*
Meticulous, Painstaking, Diligent, Systematic, Scrutiny	adjective/noun	careful, thorough and methodical	*The audit was (meticulous / painstaking / systematic) and the team diligent; every claim was put under close scrutiny.*
Ontological	adjective	concerning the nature of being and what really exists	*The debate turned on an ontological question about what a nation is.*
Sagacious, Sage, Prudent, Nuanced	adjective	wise and showing good judgement	*It was a (sagacious / sage / prudent) decision; his nuanced*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			reading of the data impressed the panel. Note: nuanced = alive to fine distinctions.
Systematically	adverb	in an organised, methodical way	*Records were systematically destroyed.*

🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Albeit, Whereby, Insofar, insofar as, Henceforth, Hitherto, Previously, Conceivably, Presumably, Ostensibly, Fundamentally, Electronically, Erstwhile	conjunction/adverb	Connectors, hedges and time markers that join, limit or soften a statement.	*The scheme works, (albeit / insofar as / whereby) only in part; henceforth the rule applies, hitherto it did not, and previously it was optional; (conceivably / presumably / ostensibly) it will change; fundamentally the idea is sound; forms may be filed electronically; the erstwhile chairman said nothing.*
Arguably, Purportedly	adverb	as can reasonably be claimed, or as claimed by others without proof	*It is arguably the biggest reform in a decade; the funds were purportedly spent on training.*
Cogent, Grandstanding, Performative,	adjective/noun	convincing argument, formal statements, or	*His case was cogent, the rest pure (grandstanding /*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Affirmation, Announcement, Insistence, Memorandum, Interrogation, Caveat, Litany, Querulous		speaking mainly to be seen.	*performative) talk; the (affirmation / announcement / memorandum) was read out, his insistence grew, and the interrogation produced a litany of querulous complaints despite one important caveat.*
Confound	verb	to confuse a result by mixing in a hidden cause	*Income differences confounded the study's conclusions.*
Contend, Posit	verb	to put forward a claim or idea as true so it can be debated or tested	*The authors (contend / posit) that growth alone will not cut inequality.*
Eloquent, Lucid, Limpid, Pellucid	adjective	clear, fluent and easy to follow; *eloquent* stresses persuasive skill	*Her (eloquent / lucid / limpid / pellucid) explanation won the house over.*
Elucidate, Delineate, Demonstrate, Indicate, Manifest, Underscore, Promulgate, Emanate, Analyse, Observe	verb	to make something clear, visible, known or pointed out.	*The chart (elucidates / delineates / demonstrates / indicates / manifests) the trend; the study underscored the risk, the ministry promulgated the rule, and the warning emanated from the data they analysed and observed.*
Gambit, Machination	noun	a calculated move or secret scheme made to gain advantage	*The walkout was a political gambit; the machinations of the*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			lobby were later exposed.
Methodology	noun	the set of methods used to carry out research	*The paper's methodology was criticised by statisticians.*
Normative	adjective	about how things should be, based on rules or values, not just how they are	*The report makes a normative case for free school meals.*
Notwithstanding, per se	preposition/phrase	in spite of; and *per se* = in itself, taken on its own	*Notwithstanding the delays, work continued; the rule is not unfair per se.*
Paradox, Dichotomy	noun	a self-contradictory statement, or a sharp split into two opposed parts	*It is a paradox that food-surplus states report hunger; the growth-versus-environment dichotomy dominates the debate.*
Plausible	adjective	believable and reasonable enough to be true	*The explanation is plausible but unproven.*
Qualified, Provisional, Stopgap	adjective	limited, temporary or not final; *qualified* support = support with conditions	*The party gave (qualified / provisional) backing; the ordinance is only a stopgap.*
Quandary	noun	a difficult situation where it is hard to decide what to do	*The board faced a quandary over the merger.*
Reiterate	verb	to say something again for emphasis	*The minister reiterated that no tax would rise.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Replicate	verb	to repeat a study or test to check the result holds	*No team could replicate the original finding.*
Rhetoric, Discourse, Dialectic	noun	public argument and discussion on a topic; *rhetoric* often implies empty persuasive language	*The campaign was heavy on rhetoric; the public discourse and its dialectic of opposing views produced little.*

⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Apathetic, Apathy, Jaded, Catharsis, Frustration, Sentimental, Empathy	adjective/noun	feeling nothing, worn out by too much of something, or the release of pent-up emotion.	*Voters have grown (apathetic / jaded); the apathy runs deep, and the verdict brought a strange catharsis after months of frustration.*
Ardent, Zealous, Vociferous	adjective	passionate and forceful in support of something	*He is an (ardent / zealous / vociferous) defender of press freedom. Note: vociferous stresses loudness.*
Captivate	verb	to attract and hold someone's attention completely	*Her speech captivated the audience.*
Daunt, Vex, Hubris	verb/noun	to discourage or trouble someone, or the pride that invites a fall	*The scale of the task did not daunt her, though delays continued to vex the team; the collapse was*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			a classic case of hubris.
Enthusiastic, Confidence, Aspiration, Motivation, Fascination, Attainable	noun/adjective	eagerness, self-belief and the drive to achieve something.	*Her (enthusiasm / confidence / aspiration / motivation) carried the team; the fascination with the goal never faded, and the target proved attainable.*
Invigorate	verb	to give fresh energy to	*The new coach invigorated a tired side.*
Sanguine, Halcyon	adjective	hopeful, or calm and happy	*He stayed sanguine about the outcome; they look back on the halcyon days of the 1990s.*
Vibrant, Kinetic, Robust	adjective	full of energy, movement and strength	*A (vibrant / kinetic) start-up scene and robust demand lifted the city.*
Vie, Bid, Competition, Competitive	verb/noun	to try hard to win or obtain something against others.	*Firms (vie / compete) for the contract; the bid was strong, and the competition remained fiercely competitive.*
Zeal	noun	great energy and enthusiasm for a cause	*She campaigned with missionary zeal.*

🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Scrutinise, Investigate, Probe, Assess, Gauge, Ascertain, Quantify	verb	to examine, measure or establish something; *probe* is also a noun = an investigation	*Auditors (scrutinise / investigate / probe) the accounts to (assess / gauge / ascertain) the loss and (quantify) it.*
Survey, Sample, Data, Ratio, Demographic, Traceability, Examination, Linear, Surveillance	noun/adjective	gathering, counting, tracking and studying information.	*The (survey / sample / data / ratio) showed a clear pattern; the demographic breakdown, traceability of each figure and the examination method were all checked.*

🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abide, Adhere, Compliance, Accede, Persuade, Co-opt, Stipulate	verb	to follow, agree to, or bring someone round; *compliance* is a noun = the act of obeying, *stipulate* = to set a condition	*Firms must (abide) by and (adhere) to the code, and (compliance) is checked; the state (acceded) to the demand after leaders (persuaded / co-opted) the rebels, and the pact (stipulates) an annual review.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Accord, Consensus, Coalition, Cohesion, Combination, Convergence, Negotiation, Conference, Parley, Ratification	noun	a coming-together, a deal, or the process of reaching one; *ratification* = the formal approval that makes a deal binding	*After long (negotiation / parley) at the (conference), the (coalition) reached an (accord) by (consensus); the (combination / convergence / cohesion) of views survived (ratification).*
co-/con-, co/con, uni	prefix	prefixes meaning 'with / together' (co-, con-) and 'one' (uni-)	*(co-/con-) gives cooperate, connect, coexist; (co/con) gives collaborate, contract; (uni) gives unite, unique, universe.*
Coalesce, Converge, Reconcile, Mediate, Arbitrate, Convene	verb	to bring or come together, or to settle differences; *mediate* = help two sides agree, *arbitrate* = decide as a neutral judge	*The factions (coalesce / converge) once talks (reconcile) their demands; the panel was (convened) to (mediate / arbitrate) the dispute.*
Cohesive, Compatible, Multilateral, Unilateral, Aggregate, Cumulative, Incremental	adjective	united, matching, or added together; *unilateral* = done alone, *multilateral* = by many together	*A (cohesive / compatible) team took the (multilateral) route rather than a (unilateral) one; the (aggregate / cumulative) effect of (incremental) steps was large.*
Rapprochement, Reconciliation, Collaboration, Cooperation, Cooperative, Collective,	noun/verb	working together, giving way, or restoring good relations after trouble.	*The talks produced (rapprochement / reconciliation); (collaboration / cooperation) replaced hostility, both sides*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Acquiesce, Accommodate, Concede, Inclusive, Relationships, Hospitality, Invitation			*acquiesced and conceded ground, and the new cooperative accommodated every stakeholder.*

⭐ Certainty, Importance & Authority ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Conscription	noun	Involuntary labor, especially military service, demanded by some established authority	*The pair also butted heads over Mr Fedorov's plans to improve recruitment and training to reduce the deep anger created by the conscription system .*
Conspicuous, Palpable, Pronounced, Discernible, Salient, Explicit, Notable, Notifiable, Distinctive, Characteristic, Facet	adjective	easy to see, notice or single out.	*The shift was (conspicuous / palpable / pronounced / discernible / salient); the wording was explicit, the finding (notable / distinctive), and each characteristic facet was set out.*
Impeccable, Inimitable, Irresistible, Epitome, Quintessential, Pristine	adjective/noun	so good that it cannot be faulted or copied. Epitome and quintessential = the perfect example of a type; pristine = spotless or untouched.	*Her record is (impeccable / inimitable / irresistible); she is the (epitome / quintessential example) of a public*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			servant, and the site remains pristine.
Inevitable, Ineluctable, Inexorable, Indubitable, Unequivocal	adjective	certain, unstoppable or beyond doubt; *inexorable* stresses that nothing can halt it	*Defeat looked (inevitable / ineluctable / inexorable); the evidence was (indubitable / unequivocal).*
Inherent, Intrinsic, Innate, Indispensable, Requisite, Cardinal	adjective/noun	belonging to something by its very nature, or absolutely required.	*Risk is (inherent / intrinsic / innate) in the job; trust is (indispensable / requisite) for progress, and openness is a cardinal principle.*
Investigating NEW	verb	inquire into or study in order to ascertain facts or information	*Fire kills 10 members of same family in Peru, police say Authorities are investigating the cause of the blaze in Lima as local media report it may have been arson.*
Paramount, Predominant, Incumbent, Mandate, Remit, Legislative, Democracy, Sovereignty, Autonomy, Privatisation	noun	authority, its scope, or its source; *paramount / predominant* are adjectives = above all others, *incumbent* = the current office-holder or a binding duty	*Safety is (paramount) and the (predominant) concern; the (incumbent) claims a (mandate) within the (remit) of the (legislative) branch, which in a (democracy) rests on (sovereignty) and regional (autonomy); (privatisation) was approved.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Unequivocally, Ergo, Hence, Thereby, Thus	adverb	words that link a conclusion to its reason, or state it without doubt	*The data is clear; (ergo / hence / thus / thereby) the policy fails, and the panel (unequivocally) rejected it.*

🌫 Hidden, Unclear & Secret ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Arcane, Cryptic, Esoteric, Recondite, Abstruse	adjective	mysterious, obscure and understood by only a few	*The rules are (arcane / cryptic / esoteric / recondite / abstruse) even to lawyers.*
Clandestine, Furtive	adjective	done secretly to avoid notice, often something illicit	*The (clandestine / furtive) meetings were caught on camera.*
Divulge	verb	to reveal secret information	*The officer refused to divulge the source.*
Gloss over, Belie	verb	to hide or play down something bad so it seems less serious	*The report (glossed over / belied) the true scale of the losses.*
Latent, Underlying	adjective	existing but not yet visible or active; lying beneath the surface	*The (latent / underlying) causes of the unrest went unaddressed.*
Obfuscation	noun	deliberately making something confusing to hide the truth	*The reply was pure obfuscation.*
Surreptitious, Inscrutable, Enigmatic, Abscond, Aloof, Insular,	adjective/verb	kept out of sight, held back, or impossible to read or interpret.	*His (surreptitious / inscrutable / enigmatic) conduct raised doubts; he absconded before the*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Dormant, Liminal, Ineffable			*inquiry, staying (aloof / insular) from colleagues, while the case sat dormant at a liminal stage.*
Tacit, Implicit	adjective	understood or implied without being said directly	*There was (tacit / implicit) approval from the top.*
Transparent	adjective	letting light through; open and easy to see into (opposite of opaque)	*The process must be transparent and auditable.*
Veneer	noun	a thin, often false, outer appearance	*Beneath the veneer of order lay deep dysfunction.*

 Real, Concrete & Practical ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Tangible, Pragmatic	adjective	real and practical rather than theoretical	*Voters want tangible results and a pragmatic approach.*
Vaccination	noun	giving a vaccine to protect against a disease	*A mass (vaccination) drive covered every district.*

 Reject, Revenge & Force ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Depose, Oust, Usurp, Wrest, Annex, Annexation, Coup, Insurrection	verb	to seize power or territory by force, or to throw someone out of it; *annexation / coup / insurrection* are nouns naming such acts	*Generals (deposed / ousted) the president and (usurped / wrested) control in a (coup); the (insurrection) let them (annex) the border district, an (annexation) no one recognised.*
Insurmountable, Indomitable, Impervious, Indefatigable, Tenacious, Incessant, Insatiable, Sustained	adjective	so strong, fixed or persistent that nothing can overcome, affect or exhaust it.	*The lead looked (insurmountable / indomitable); he was impervious to criticism, (indefatigable / tenacious) in his work, and the incessant, insatiable demand was sustained for years.*
Reprisal, Retaliation, Jeopardise, Abrogate, Annul	noun	revenge, or the cancelling / risking of something; *jeopardise* = to put at risk, *abrogate / annul* = to cancel officially	*Fear of (reprisal / retaliation) grew; the strike would (jeopardise) the truce, and parliament moved to (abrogate / annul) the treaty.*

⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abrupt	adjective	sudden and unexpected	*The scheme came to an abrupt end.*
Belated	adjective	coming later than it should	*A belated apology was issued.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Bleak, Dismal, Despondent, Lugubrious	adjective	gloomy and without hope; *despondent* describes a person's low mood	*The outlook was (bleak / dismal); relatives looked (despondent / lugubrious) outside the hospital.*
Disenchant	verb	to make someone lose hope or trust	*Voters were disenchanted by the broken promises.*
Ephemeral, Transient	adjective	lasting only a very short time	*The gains proved (ephemeral / transient).*
Harbinger	noun	a sign of something to come	*The rains were a harbinger of a good harvest.*
Juncture, Preliminary, Prevailing, Prospective, Trajectory, Unprecedented, Anticipatory, Precedence, Preparation, Preservation	noun/adjective	words marking when something happens or where it falls in an order.	*At this (juncture) the preliminary stage ended; the prevailing view is that the prospective trajectory is upward, which would be unprecedented; anticipatory planning took precedence over preparation.*
Lull	noun/verb	a quiet or calm period	*There was a brief lull in the fighting.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Sporadic, Peripatetic, Sedentary, Occurrence, Appearance, Disappearance, Destination, Introduction, Inveterate, Capricious, Unpredictable	adjective/noun	how often or how much something moves or happens.	*Attacks were (sporadic / occasional); the peripatetic inspector kept moving while the sedentary staff stayed put; each occurrence, appearance and disappearance was logged.*

🎭 Lies, Trickery & Deception ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Chicanery	noun	clever trickery used to deceive	*The deal was pushed through by legal chicanery.*
Deceive, Dissemble, Beguile, Prevaricate	verb	to mislead by hiding the truth; *beguile* also = to charm; *prevaricate* = to dodge rather than lie outright	*He set out to (deceive / dissemble / beguile) investors; the witness prevaricated for an hour.*
Dubious	adjective	doubtful and possibly not honest or true	*The firm has a dubious record on safety.*
Fabricate	verb	to make up something false	*The dossier was entirely fabricated.*
Mendacious, Duplicitous, Spurious, Specious	adjective	false or dishonest; *specious* = looks correct but is actually false; *duplicitous* = two-faced	*The (mendacious / duplicitous) testimony rested on (spurious / specious) claims.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Sycophant, Sycophancy, Unctuous, Glib, Facile, Servile	noun/adjective	excessive false praise given to win favour, or smooth but hollow speech.	*The court is full of (sycophants / sycophancy); his (glib / unctuous / facile) praise fooled nobody, and the servile staff never disagreed.*

 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Adversity, Plight, Predicament, Quagmire, Morass, Imbroglio, Conundrum	noun	a difficult, messy or confusing situation	*The migrants' plight worsened; the government is stuck in a (quagmire / morass / imbroglio / predicament) of its own making and faces the conundrum of how to exit; she rose despite great adversity.*
Bane, Disadvantages	noun	a cause of trouble; a drawback	*Corruption is the bane of the system; the disadvantages of the scheme soon became clear.*
Demarcate	verb	to mark out boundaries or limits	*The order demarcates the forest area.*
Grapple, Tackle, Extricate	verb	to struggle with and deal with a difficulty	*The state must (grapple with / tackle) rising debt and extricate itself from bad contracts.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Hurdle, Setback	noun	a problem that blocks or delays progress	*The verdict is a major (hurdle / setback) for the project.*
Jettison	verb	to throw away or abandon something	*The party jettisoned the proposal after the backlash.*
Reprieve, Respite	noun	a short break or relief from trouble	*The rain brought a brief (reprieve / respite) from the heat.*

🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Cite, Warrant, Simulation	verb	to give as a reason or justify it; *simulation* is a noun = a modelled run used to predict behaviour	*Officials (cite) new data that (warrants) a review, backed by a computer (simulation).*
flect/flex, flu/flux, ject, spec/spect	root	Latin roots: flect/flex = bend, flu/flux = flow, ject = throw, spec/spect = see or look	*(flect/flex) gives reflect, flexible; (flu/flux) gives fluent, influx; (ject) gives reject, eject; (spec/spect) gives inspect, spectator.*
Mull, Deliberate, Reckon, Infer, Discern, Anticipation, Experience	verb	to think, work out or perceive; *deliberate* also = done on purpose (adj.), *anticipation / experience* are nouns for expecting and for what you have lived through	*The board will (mull / deliberate) the plan and (reckon) the cost; from the data you can (infer / discern) a trend; (anticipation) ran high, and (experience) shaped the verdict.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Surmise, Postulate, Extrapolate, Speculation, Speculative, Hypothesis, Projection, Derive, Dwell, Synthesis, Reminiscent, Epistemic, Consciousness, Intelligence	verb/noun	to work something out, guess it from clues, or turn it over in the mind.	*Analysts (surmise / postulate / extrapolate) from thin data; the (hypothesis / projection / speculation) is speculative at best, though it derives from real evidence; he dwelt on it for weeks before offering a synthesis.*

⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Candid, Forthright, Veracious	adjective	honest, direct and truthful in what one says	*She gave a (candid / forthright / veracious) account of the failures.*
Credible, Tenable, Evidence, Fidelity, Exculpate, Exoneration, Unanimous	adjective/noun	believable, defensible or backed by proof; also being cleared of blame.	*The claim is (credible / tenable) and the evidence supports it; his fidelity to the facts was total, the inquiry exculpated him, and the exoneration was unanimous.*
Devout	adjective	deeply religious or sincerely committed	*He was a devout follower of the movement.*
Equitable	adjective	fair and just to all	*The panel urged a more equitable sharing of river water.*
Hindsight	noun	understanding a situation only after it	*In hindsight, the warning signs were*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		has happened	*obvious.*
Lenient, Forbearance	adjective/noun	not strict; patient and self-controlled in the face of provocation	*The judge was lenient; the state showed unusual forbearance.*
Mitigation	noun	action taken to make a problem less serious	*Flood mitigation works were funded this year.*
Partisan, Divisive	adjective	one-sided and splitting people into hostile camps	*The bill was (partisan / divisive) from the start.*
Redress, Rectify	verb/noun	to correct or set right a wrong	*The tribunal exists to (redress / rectify) such grievances.*
Repatriate	verb	to send someone back to their own country	*Hundreds of workers were repatriated after the war.*
Rescind	verb	to cancel or take back an order or decision	*The ministry rescinded the circular within a week.*
Sanctimonious, Histrionic, Grandiose	adjective	putting on a false show - of moral superiority, of emotion, or of grandeur	*The speech was (sanctimonious / histrionic / grandiose) and short on detail.*
Veracity	noun	truthfulness; accuracy (root VER = truth)	*The court questioned the veracity of the affidavit.*

🌀 Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Animosity, Acrimony, Rancour	noun	strong bitter hostility and resentment	*The talks collapsed amid (animosity /*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		between people	*acrimony / rancour).*
Dissolute, Licentious	adjective	behaving without moral restraint	*The court described his (dissolute / licentious) conduct.*
Forge	verb	to build or create a bond; or, in the other sense, to fake a document	*The two states forged a water-sharing pact; he was jailed for forging signatures.*
Hostile, Inimical, Virulent, Vituperative	adjective	showing strong enmity or doing active harm; *vituperative* = bitterly abusive in words	*The climate was (hostile / inimical) to investment; his (virulent / vituperative) attacks drew censure.*
Indelible	adjective	impossible to remove or erase	*The riots left an indelible mark on the city.*
Labyrinthine	adjective	extremely complicated and confusing, like a maze	*The subsidy rules are labyrinthine.*
Recalcitrant, Implacable	adjective	stubbornly refusing to obey or to be calmed	*The (recalcitrant / implacable) faction blocked every compromise.*

👑 Power, Control & Influence ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Clout, Hegemony, Wield, Capacity, Propensity	noun	power or influence and the ability to use it; *wield* is a verb = to hold and use power, *propensity* = a natural tendency	*A bloc with real (clout) exercises (hegemony) and (wields) it freely, given the (capacity) to act and a (propensity) to intervene.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Interlocutor, Palliative, Tariff	noun	instruments or roles used to manage a situation; *palliative* = a stop-gap that relieves but does not cure	*An (interlocutor) was appointed; the relief package was a mere (palliative), and the (tariff) stayed in place.*

😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Ameliorate	verb	to make a bad situation better	*The grant helped ameliorate rural distress.*
Assuage, Mollify, Placate	verb	to calm or soothe someone who is angry or upset	*The package was meant to (assuage / mollify / placate) the protesters.*
Buoyant, Jubilant, Jovial, Genial	adjective	cheerful and in high spirits; *buoyant* also = economically strong	*The crowd was (jubilant / jovial); the host was genial and markets stayed buoyant.*
Impressive	adjective	Making, or tending to make, a positive impression	*On the Grand Road of Puri The Jagannatha temple in the city in Odisha is an impressive place of worship, and the grand festival of the deity is incomparable*
Phlegmatic, Nonchalant	adjective	calm and unbothered, showing little emotion or concern	*He remained (phlegmatic / nonchalant) through the crisis.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Quixotic	adjective	unrealistic and impractical in a hopeful, idealistic way	*It was a quixotic bid for the presidency.*

🌑 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Adverse, Detrimental, Deleterious, Noxious, Baleful, Ominous, Grim, Harrowing, Lachrymose	adjective	harmful, threatening or deeply unpleasant; *noxious* = poisonous, *ominous / baleful* = warning of coming evil, *lachrymose* = tearful	*(Adverse / detrimental / deleterious / noxious) fumes filled the street; the (baleful / ominous / grim) forecast made for a (harrowing), (lachrymose) night.*
Cacophony, Embarrassments	noun	an unpleasant clash of sound, or acute discomfort	*A (cacophony) of horns drowned the speech, adding to the government's (embarrassments).*
Draconian, Stark, Incendiary, Wanton, Galvanic	adjective	extremely harsh, blunt or inflaming	*The (draconian) order and its (stark) wording were (incendiary); (wanton) destruction followed, with a (galvanic) effect on protesters.*
Endemic, Subprime, Ineffective	adjective	a settled or low-grade bad condition; *endemic* = always present in a place or group, *subprime* = high-risk and poor quality	*Corruption is (endemic) here; (subprime) lending and (ineffective) oversight caused the crash.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Futile	adjective	useless because it cannot work	*Further talks would be futile.*
Insidious, Insidiously, Pernicious, Malignant, Malevolent, Vindictive, Machinations	adjective	harmful in a hidden, spiteful or scheming way; *insidiously* is the adverb, *machinations* a noun = secret harmful plotting	*(Insidious / pernicious / malignant) rumours spread (insidiously); (malevolent / vindictive) rivals and their (machinations) did the rest.*
mal-	prefix	prefix meaning 'bad' or 'badly'	*(mal-) gives malfunction, malnutrition, maltreat.*
Negligence, Impunity, Contaminate, Inadvertent, Inappropriate, Unacceptable, Unacknowledged, Profane	noun/adjective/verb	failing in a duty, or acting in a way that damages, pollutes or offends.	*The (negligence / impunity) was inexcusable; officials contaminated the site, acted (inadvertently / inappropriately), and used profane, unacceptable language that went unacknowledged.*
Squalid, Putrid, Macabre, Brittle, Desiccation, Malnutrition	adjective/noun	filthy, rotting, brittle or grimly unpleasant.	*Families live in (squalid / putrid) conditions; the macabre scene shocked inspectors; the brittle pipes and desiccation of the soil worsened malnutrition.*

📦 Amount, Size & Plenty ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Abound	verb	to exist in large numbers; to be plentiful	*Rumours abound about a cabinet reshuffle.*
Abundant, Ample, Copious, Profuse	adjective	existing in large, more-than-enough quantities	*The region has (abundant / ample / copious / profuse) rainfall.*
Affordability	noun	extent to which something is affordable, as measured by its cost relative to the amount that the purchaser is able to pay	*First-time home buyers are feeling the squeeze of higher interest rates with mortgage affordability at its worst level for 16 years.*
Avarice	noun	extreme greed for wealth	*Corporate avarice drove the collapse.*
Average, Approximate	noun/adjective	the typical middle value; close to but not exactly correct	*The average yield was about four tonnes, an approximate figure at best.*
Concise, Laconic	adjective	using very few words; short and clear	*His reply was (concise / laconic).*
Dearth, Paucity	noun	a serious shortage or very small amount of something	*There is a (dearth / paucity) of reliable district-level data.*
Decimate	verb	to destroy a large part of something; stronger than *reduce*	*The drought decimated the cattle herd.*
Deficient, Meagre, Marginal	adjective	not enough; very small in amount	*The diet was (deficient / meagre); the gains were marginal.*
Exorbitant, Hefty	adjective	far too high or large in price, amount or	*Patients were charged (exorbitant / hefty)*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		weight	*fees.*
Extraordinary, Existential, Evacuation, Ammunition	adjective/noun	how far something reaches, or how far outside the ordinary it falls.	*The response was (extraordinary / existential) in scale; the evacuation used all the ammunition and manpower available.*
Panacea	noun	a supposed cure for all problems (usually said it is NOT one)	*Technology is no panacea for rural poverty.*
Plethora, Surfeit, Myriad	noun	a very large number or an excess of something	*The scheme drew a (plethora / surfeit / myriad) of complaints.*
Stifle	verb	to stop something from developing or being expressed	*The law stifles dissent.*
Substantial	adjective	large in size or amount	*A substantial share of the budget went unspent.*
Superfluous, Redundant	adjective	more than is needed; unnecessary	*The clause was (superfluous / redundant) and was dropped.*
Surplus	noun	the extra amount left when income is more than spending	*The state recorded a revenue surplus this year.*
Unbridled, Unfettered	adjective	not controlled or held back; without limits	*(Unbridled / Unfettered) construction choked the wetland.*

□ Difference, Comparison & Opposite ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Antithesis, Converse	noun	the exact opposite of something	*His conduct is the (antithesis / converse) of everything the office stands for.*
Difference	noun	the quality of being unlike; a disparity	*The difference between the two states is stark.*
Dwarf	verb	to make something else look small by comparison	*The new plant dwarfs every rival in the region.*

 Catch, Hold & Seize ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
cap/cept, ten/tain, duc/duct, fract/frag, de-, vac	root	word roots and prefixes that build many editorial words	*cap/cept = take (capture, accept); ten/tain = hold (retain, contain); duc/duct = lead (conduct, induce); fract/frag = break (fracture, fragment); de- = down or remove (decrease, devalue); vac = empty (vacant, evacuate).*
Nab	verb	to catch or arrest someone	*Police nabbed the suspect at the airport.*

 Cause, Effect & Consequence ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Adjacent, Contiguous, Contingent, Dependence, Implication, Comprise, Factor in, Correspondents, Alternative, Circumstances, Considerations, Considerable, Stakeholder, Manifold	adjective/noun	lying next to, linked with, or relying on something else.	*The two plots are (adjacent / contiguous); the payout is contingent on audit, the dependence on imports is total, and every implication must be factored in.*
Aftermath, Fallout, Outcome, Ramification, Repercussion, Corollary	noun	what follows from an event; *corollary* = something that logically follows, *repercussion / fallout* = the indirect bad after-effects	*In the (aftermath), the (fallout / repercussions / ramifications) were severe; the (outcome) was a natural (corollary) of the decision.*
Allegiance	noun	Loyalty to some cause, nation or ruler	*Now it shows how flimsy that allegiance is It's the World Cup final , so you pick a side.*
Consequential	adjective	Following as a result	*The most consequential fixture in international sport was, as it turned out, little more than a grand cosplay for the New Jersey leisure market.*
Engender, Breed, Inflict, Wreak, Attribute, Causation, Factor	verb	to cause or produce something, or to name the cause; *causation / factor*	*Delay (engenders / breeds) anger and (inflicts / wreaks) real damage; analysts*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		are nouns = the causal link and a contributing cause	*(attribute) this to one (factor), though (causation) is unproven.*
Hinge, Entail, Offset	verb	to depend on, require, or balance out	*Success (hinges) on funding, which (entails) new taxes; savings elsewhere (offset) the cost.*

▲ Highest & Lowest Points ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Nadir	noun	the lowest or worst point	*Relations between the two countries hit their nadir that year.*
Zenith, Heyday, Culminate	noun/verb	the highest or most successful point	*The party was at its (zenith / heyday) in 1984; the protests culminated in a march on the capital.*

🗨 Talkative, Loud & Wordy ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Bombastic, Grandiloquent, Turgid, Florid	adjective	high-sounding, inflated and empty in language	*The speech was (bombastic / grandiloquent / turgid / florid) but said nothing new.*
Garrulous, Loquacious	adjective	talking far too much	*A (garrulous / loquacious) witness held up the hearing.*

🦅 Boldness, Recklessness & Daring ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Audacious, Intrepid	adjective	very bold and fearless, sometimes shockingly so	*It was an (audacious / intrepid) rescue attempt.*
Impetuous, Headlong	adjective/adverb	acting fast without thinking; rushing in recklessly	*The impetuous decision was made headlong, without consulting anyone.*

😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Astute, Perspicacious	adjective	clever and shrewd, with sharp insight	*It was an (astute / perspicacious) reading of the market.*
Diffident, Reticent, Reluctant, Circumspect	adjective	holding back - through shyness, unwillingness, or careful caution	*He was (diffident / reticent / reluctant) about speaking; the ministry stayed circumspect on the figures.*
Keen	adjective	eager, or sharply aware and perceptive	*She was keen to start, and had a keen eye for detail.*
Taciturn	adjective	habitually saying very little	*The taciturn official gave one-word answers.*

□ Unity, Sameness & Division ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Consecutive	noun	sequence of notes or chords that results from repeated shifts in pitch of the same interval	*US renews strikes on Iran as Trump threatens to attack underground nuclear site The US president's threat to target a key Iranian nuclear site came ahead of the 11th consecutive night of attacks.*
Homogeneous, Concurrent, Discrete	adjective	alike, simultaneous, or separately distinct	*The sample was homogeneous; the two trials were concurrent; the syllabus is split into discrete units.*
Juxtapose	verb	to place things side by side for comparison	*The film juxtaposes rural poverty with urban excess.*

🌟 Quality, Character & Behaviour ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Accidentally, Unintentionally	adverb	without meaning to	*The file was (accidentally / unintentionally) deleted.*
Administrations 🆕	noun	act of administering	*Heads of devolved administrations are also adept at claiming credit when things go well and, when they go badly, diverting the blame on to national government.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Affable, Amiable, Cordial, Gregarious, Suave, Urbane, Amity	adjective	pleasant, warm and easy to get on with. Suave and urbane add smooth social polish; gregarious = fond of company.	*The host was (affable / amiable / cordial / gregarious); his (suave / urbane) manner put everyone at ease.*
Authentic, bona fide	adjective	genuine and real, not fake	*The manuscript is (authentic / bona fide).*
Brusque	adjective	abrupt and rude in manner	*His brusque reply ended the meeting.*
Coherent, Comprehensive, Germane, Pertinent	adjective	clear, complete and to the point	*We need a (coherent / comprehensive) policy; only (germane / pertinent) evidence was admitted.*
Controversially, Horrendously, Excruciatingly, Architecturally	adverb	adverbs of manner formed from common editorial adjectives	*Controversially, the bench went further; the scheme was horrendously mismanaged; progress was excruciatingly slow; architecturally, the building is a landmark.*
Environmentally 🆕	adverb	In a manner affecting the environment	*Buried questions: On the Sikkim tunnel accident The costs of projects in environmentally fragile zones are many*
Fastidious, Pedantic, Pernickety	adjective	overly concerned with small details, rules or standards.	*His (fastidious / pedantic / pernickety) checking slowed the whole process.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Haughty, Supercilious, Imperious, Pompous, Pretentious, Insolent, Churlish, Obstreperous, Gauche	adjective	behaving as if better than everyone else, or plainly ill-mannered.	*The minister's (haughty / supercilious / imperious / pompous / pretentious) reply angered the house; his (insolent / churlish / obstreperous) aide was worse, and the new recruit was merely gauche.*
Illusory, Ostensible, Elusive	adjective	not what it appears to be, or hard to pin down	*The gains proved (illusory / ostensible); a lasting settlement remains elusive.*
Immaculate, Exemplary, Paragon, Incomparable	noun/adjective	faultless; a perfect model of excellence	*His record is (immaculate / exemplary); she is a paragon of public service and, in her field, incomparable.*
Importance, Endorsement	noun	worth or note, and public backing	*The court stressed the importance of the right; the campaign won a celebrity endorsement.*
Improvisational	adjective	Having the nature of an improvisation	*A Soviet-schooled military officer deeply embedded within institutions tussled with a young civilian disruptor taking a more agile, improvisational approach.*
Irresponsibility	noun	the state of not being answerable for one's	*The report blamed official irresponsibility*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		actions	*for the lapse.*
Legitimacy, de jure	noun/adjective	rightful and lawful standing	*The government's legitimacy was questioned; de jure the office is elected, in practice it is not.*
Pulchritude, Mellifluous, Euphony, Embellish, Entertainment, Performance	noun/adjective/verb	physically beautiful, sweet to the ear, or made more attractive.	*Her (pulchritude / mellifluous voice) drew crowds; the euphony of the hall was perfect, the stage was embellished, and the entertainment and performance were flawless.*
Pusillanimous	adjective	cowardly and lacking courage	*The pusillanimous response emboldened the attackers.*
Sanitation, Eligibility	noun	public-service terms: waste management, and the right to qualify	*Sanitation coverage rose sharply; eligibility for the scheme was widened.*

Other & Mixed ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Accountable	adjective	Obliged, when called upon, to answer	*The Grim Lessons of Israel's War in Gaza Israel has not been held accountable for its actions in Gaza.*
Announcements	noun	act of announcing, or giving notice	*If Mr Burnham agrees, he will have to wait before making any big announcements.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Apocalyptic	noun	One who predicts apocalypse	*Given the somewhat apocalyptic conditions, getting dressed to go to the office is the last thing anyone wants to think about, mainly because it feels wrong to be working.*
Civilization NEW	noun	organized culture encompassing many communities, often on the scale of a nation or a people	*Three speeches on a single day signaled a dying American democracy | Robert Shpiner Stephen Miller warned of a leftwing 'cancer' threatening civilization.*
Commercial	noun	advertisement in a common media format, usually radio or television	*The last time America hosted, the problem wasn't commercial overkill so much as sheer shrugging apathy.*
Contradiction NEW	noun	act of contradicting	*The apparent contradiction – fortifying the centre to pursue an agenda of decentralisation – arises from a perversity in the way the British state works or, rather, fails to work .*
Decentralisation NEW	noun	action of decentralizing, or the state of being decentralized	*The apparent contradiction – fortifying the centre to pursue an agenda of decentralisation –*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			arises from a perversity in the way the British state works or, rather, fails to work .
Devolution NEW	noun	rolling down	*But genuine control, especially when it comes to fiscal policy, has not matched the rhetoric of devolution.*
Distribution	noun	act of distributing or state of being distributed	*Lists of folly: On the Supreme Court, the SIR and benefits A flawed SIR should not be the basis for distribution of benefits*
Homelessness NEW	noun	state of being homeless	*But I wasn't in the space of wanting to play semantics with it." Daniel Lavelle writes on mental health, homelessness and social care.*
Impossible	noun	impossibility	*An article in the Observer concluded that Vienna shows "decent homes for all" is not an impossible dream.*
Improbable NEW	adjective	Not likely to be true	*The garish half-time show curated by Chris Martin of Coldplay seemed to reinforce that – but then came a moment of improbable genius.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Incongruities	noun	state of being incongruous, or lacking congruence	*The MetLife Stadium on Sunday night was a melting pot of colliding incongruities and temporary identities.*
Independent	noun	candidate or voter not affiliated with any political party, a freethinker, free of a party platform	*Diana Berg is a Ukrainian artist, writer and cultural manager from Mariupol, and the founder of Platform TU, an independent cultural initiative now operating in exile after Russia's full-scale invasion.*
Initiative	noun	beginning	*Battling drug abuse: On Kerala's Operation Toofan Kerala has shown initiative in coordinated action against cartels*
Inspiration	noun	drawing of air into the lungs, accomplished in mammals by elevation of the chest walls and flattening of the diaphragm, as part of the act o	*Fast fashion and mall brands used to look to the runways for inspiration.*
Installation	noun	act of installing	*My street now resembles an art installation, with varying colours and patterns of bed sheets taped to windows in*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			the battle against the heat.
Institutions	noun	custom or practice of a society or community	*A Soviet-schooled military officer deeply embedded within institutions tussled with a young civilian disruptor taking a more agile, improvisational approach.*
Intellectuals NEW	noun	intelligent, learned person, especially one who discourses about learned matters	*In the early 20th century, Chinese intellectuals sought to capture the harsh realities of working-class lives.*
Investment	noun	act of investing, or state of being invested	*The CETA can reshape trade and investment flows, create quality jobs and growth, and transition India to a more competitive and innovation-driven economy*
Journalist	noun	keeper of a personal journal, who writes in it regularly	*María Ramírez is a journalist and deputy managing editor of elDiario.es, a news outlet in Spain Do you have an opinion on the issues raised in this article?*
Photographing	verb	take a photograph of	*On a crowded train of people mostly staring obliviously at our own phones, a stranger had been covertly*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			photographing that little girl over and over again.
Preference	noun	selection of one thing or person over others	*Yet Burnham's support for the government's suffocating fiscal rules – and his preference for the vaguer language of "public control" over public ownership – had already raised doubts about how far he was prepared to go.*
Presumption NEW	noun	act of presuming, or something presumed	*As a critical care doctor, I have a response to his diagnosis The presumption that US elections are legitimate died last week in Washington.*
Progressives	noun	person who actively favors or strives for progress towards improved conditions, as in society or government	*That a self-described leftwing party could have such success by fixing on Mexico's chasmic inequality has drawn attention from hopeful progressives worldwide.*
Prominence NEW	noun	state of being prominent	*Reforms in recent years have created institutions with varying degrees of local autonomy – elected mayoralties like the one in*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			Manchester that afforded Mr Burnham a platform for national prominence.
Punishment	noun	act or process of punishing, imposing and/or applying a sanction	*Voters reserve the greatest punishment for the politicians they think acted too little, or too late, to prevent them getting poorer.*
Questionable	adjective	Problematic	*That was always a questionable assertion, given the defining postwar role of Labour in shaping a fairer social settlement.*
Significance	noun	extent to which something matters	*Social care has personal significance for Mr Burnham.*
Traditional NEW	noun	person with traditional beliefs	*"I wasn't making what you would call a traditional target," the mayor said.*

🧬 Word Roots, Prefixes & Latin Phrases ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
a priori, de facto, per capita, inter alia, nota bene, prima facie, pro rata, status quo, vice versa, vis-a-vis, ad hoc	phrase	Set Latin and formal expressions common in editorial, legal and economic writing.	*A priori reasoning needs no data; a de facto ruler holds power without the title; income is compared per capita; the report lists, inter alia, three reforms;*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
			nota bene, the deadline is fixed; funds are shared pro rata; prima facie the case stands; the status quo remains; vis-a-vis last year growth is slower, and vice versa applies too; the panel was set up on an ad hoc basis.
bene, bene-	prefix	bene and bene- mean 'good' or 'well'.	*The root (bene / bene-) gives benefit, benefactor and benevolent.*
bio, vita/viv, nat, gen, carn, anthrop, mort, geo, hydro, therm, photo, path	root	Greek/Latin roots about living things and the natural world: bio & vita/viv = life, nat = born, gen = birth or race, carn = flesh, anthrop = human, mort = death, geo = earth, hydro = water, therm = heat, photo = light, path = feeling or disease.	*Roots unlock new words: (bio) gives biology, (geo) gives geography, (mort) gives mortality.*
mono, bi, tri, semi-, multi, poly, omni, max, min, over-, under-, equ	prefix	Prefixes showing how many or how much: mono = one, bi = two, tri = three, semi- = half, multi/poly = many, omni = all, max = greatest, min = small or less, over- = too much, under- = too little, equ = equal.	*Add the prefix (mono / bi / tri) to get monorail, bicycle and triangle.*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
port, fer, tract, mit/miss, vert/vers, pos/pon, rupt, scrib/script, graph/gram	root	Roots about carrying, moving, writing and breaking: port, fer and tract = carry or pull, mit/miss = send, vert/vers = turn, pos/pon = place or put, rupt = break, scrib/script and graph/gram = write or draw.	*The root (port / fer / tract) gives transport, transfer and tractor.*
pre-, fore-, post-, ex-, sub-, inter-, intra-, trans-, tele	prefix	Prefixes showing position or time: pre- and fore- = before or front, post- = after, ex- = out or former, sub- = under or below, inter- = between, intra- = within, trans- = across, tele = far.	*The prefix (pre- / post- / trans-) fixes time or direction: preview, postwar, transport.*
psych, cogn, sci, fid, sens/sent, aud, vid/vis, phon, doc, phil, am/amor, chron, chrono, ann/enn, auto	root	Roots about the mind, knowing, trusting and the senses: psych = mind, cogn & sci = know, fid = faith or trust, sens/sent = feel, aud = hear, vid/vis = see, phon = sound, doc = teach, phil & am/amor = love, chron/chrono = time, ann/enn = year, auto = self.	*The root (psych / cogn / vid-vis) appears in psychology, recognise and vision; (fid) gives fidelity, and (ann/enn) gives annual.*
un-, non-, in-/im-/il-/ir-, anti-	prefix	Prefixes that reverse or oppose a meaning: un-, non- and in-/im-/il-/ir- all	*Put (un- / non- / in-im-il-ir-) before a word to negate it:*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
		mean 'not'; anti- means 'against'.	*unhappy, non-stop, impossible.*

🏛️ Polity, Government & Civics ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Conservative, Progressive, Revolutionary, Maverick, Iconoclast, Hegemon, Gerontocracy, Envoy, Geopolitical, International, Pariah	noun/adjective	people and powers defined by their political stance or dominance.	*A (conservative / progressive / revolutionary) wing formed; the maverick iconoclast defied the hegemon, the gerontocracy sent an envoy, and the pariah state was frozen out of geopolitical talks.*
Franchise, Suffrage, Electorate, Constituency, Plebiscite, Gerrymander, Delimitation, Registration, Representation, Representatives, Participation, Grassroots, Mobilisation	noun/verb	the right to vote and the machinery of elections and representation.	*Every adult has the (franchise / suffrage); the electorate of each constituency voted in a plebiscite, though delimitation was gerrymandered; registration, participation and grassroots mobilisation decide who the representatives are and how good the representation is.*
Governance, Legislation, Regulation, Constitution, Constitutional, Unconstitutional,	noun/adjective	the bodies, rules, offices and processes by which a state is run.	*Good (governance / legislation / regulation) rests on the constitution; parliament debates it, the polity accepts it,*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Parliament, Parliamentary, Polity, Jurisprudence, Impeachment, Prosecution, Enforcement, Administrative, Institutional, Institutionalised, Establishment, Inspectorate, Presidential, Tenet			*and jurisprudence interprets it; impeachment, prosecution and enforcement follow when constitutional limits are broken.*
Nationalism, Xenophobia, Antisemitism, Diaspora, Asylum, Immigration, Indigenous, Civilisation, Radicalization, Partisanship, Ideological	noun/adjective	ideas about who belongs to a nation, who is kept out, and who leads it.	*Rising (nationalism / xenophobia / antisemitism) hardened attitudes; the diaspora sought asylum, immigration dominated debate, and indigenous claims were ignored as radicalization and partisanship grew.*

🔧 Science, Work & Industry ↑ top

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Construction, Development, Innovation, Installations, Automation, Connectivity, Shipbuilding, Reindustrialised, Foundation,	noun/verb	creating, installing or expanding physical and industrial capacity.	*The (construction / development / innovation) drive rebuilt the region; new installations and automation improved connectivity, the yard resumed shipbuilding, and the area was*

Words	Part of Speech	Meaning	Example
Infrastructure, Acquisition, Deploy, Recruitment, Transformation, Transformative, Framework, Semiconductor, Cybersecurity, Irrigation, Agricultural			*reindustrialised on a firm foundation of infrastructure.*
Professional, Professionals, Occupation, Occupational, Apprenticeship, Apprenticeships, Manufacturers, Attendance, Reputation, Conventional, Individual, Adolescent, Responsibility, Responsible, Recognition	noun/adjective	jobs, the people who do them, and the training that leads to them.	*The (professional / professionals) in each occupation trained through an (apprenticeship / apprenticeships); manufacturers reported strong attendance, and the occupational standard protected their reputation.*
Scientific, Computational, Algorithmic, Technological, Neuroscience, Anthropology, University, Mythological, Testosterone, Masculinity, Breastfeeding, Environmental, Environmentalist	adjective/noun	branches of study and the language of science and technology.	*The (scientific / computational / algorithmic / technological) work spanned neuroscience, anthropology and mythological studies at the university.*

Days merged: 27 (2026-06-25, 2026-06-26, 2026-06-27, 2026-06-28, 2026-06-29, 2026-06-30, 2026-07-01, 2026-07-02, 2026-07-04, 2026-07-05, 2026-07-06, 2026-07-07, 2026-07-08, 2026-07-09, 2026-07-10, 2026-07-11, 2026-07-12, 2026-07-13, 2026-07-14, 2026-07-15, 2026-07-16, 2026-07-17, 2026-07-19, 2026-07-20, 2026-07-21, 2026-07-22, 2026-07-23)
Sources: Curated word bank + mined editorial words, consolidated into meaning-families.